1. Policy Statement

Imperial Kitchen Group Inc., shall view every customer complaint as a vital data point for maintaining our food safety standards. The company is committed to a transparent, systematic, and rapid response to all feedback, particularly those involving allegations of foodborne illness, foreign object contamination, or allergic reactions. The goal of the company is to protect public health by investigating root causes and preventing recurrence.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all complaints received via in-person reports, phone calls, social media, third-party delivery platforms, or government health agencies (e.g., DOH or LGU Health Office).

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Customer Service Representative Employee

Shall maintain an empathetic yet entirely objective tone, strictly avoiding any admissions of liability or speculation. CSRs are responsible for collecting mandatory case details, including customer contact info, exact visit date and time, the specific food consumed, and precise symptom onset times. If physical food samples are available, they must be immediately labeled with the case number and quarantined in the designated freezer for laboratory analysis. To comply with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173) and the directives of the National Privacy Commission (NPC), CSRs must read the privacy notice and obtain explicit, informed consent before processing or logging any Sensitive Personal Information (SPI), including health symptoms. This ensures strict data minimization and restricts file access solely to authorized Quality Assurance and Legal personnel.

3.2. Restaurant & Area Manager

Shall be responsible for handling initial evaluation and sorting of all incoming customer complaints based on the severity of the issue. For quality and service matters, which include issues regarding food taste, texture, temperature, or customer service, they directly manage and resolve the complaints. However, in the event of high-risk situations involving food poisoning, allergic reactions, or physical injury, they are required to immediately escalate the issue to the Area Manager or the Quality Assurance to trigger emergency investigation protocols.

3.3. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall be responsible for managing high-risk safety issues and enforcing systemic fixes across the organization. Upon receiving an escalated complaint, the team must intervene immediately and partner with the Supply Chain to conduct a 24-hour internal audit, specifically checking the cold chain and holding logs for the day in question. The QA is also tasked with monitoring systemic failures, requiring them to spearhead a mandatory, system-wide review of the relevant Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) if the exact same customer complaint occurs more than twice within a single quarter.

3.4. Supply Chain Management (SCM)

Shall be responsible for product traceability, cold chain monitoring, and strict inventory controls during food safety incidents. When a high-risk complaint triggers a 24-hour internal audit, the SCM must immediately conduct a traceability check by reviewing all delivery logs for the specific raw materials involved in the incident. Additionally, they cooperate with the QA team to verify the

cold chain and hold logs for that day. If a full crisis is triggered by multiple independent complaints about the same product, the SCM must collaborate with the Operations to physically isolate and quarantine all remaining stock of the affected product.

3.5. Learning & Development (L&D)

Shall be responsible for providing educational and instructional interventions to prevent recurring operational errors. While they are not involved in the immediate 24-hour complaint audit, they are automatically engaged if an issue becomes chronic. Specifically, if the same customer complaint is logged more than twice within a single quarter, the L&D Team is responsible for partnering with Quality Assurance to spearhead mandatory, system-wide employee retraining to correct the root cause and update staff compliance.

3.6. Crisis Management

Shall be responsible for overseeing high-level corporate governance, multi-complaint crises, and external regulatory reporting. In the event that multiple independent complaints emerge regarding a single item or raw material, the team must instantly enforce a "Stop Sale" to halt the distribution of the suspected product. Furthermore, if the underlying cause of the crisis is traced back to a commercially processed ingredient, the team assumes the responsibility of officially notifying the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) or the local health office.

4. Mandatory Response Records

4.1. Categorization

Upon receipt, the company shall categorize every complaint to determine the level of escalation:

- **Category A (High Risk):** Allegations of food poisoning, allergic reactions, or physical injury. This requires immediate escalation to the Quality Assurance or Area Manager
- **Category B (Quality):** Issues regarding taste, texture, temperature, or service. Managed by the Restaurant Manager and/or Area Manager

4.2. Information Gathering

The employee receiving a complaint must remain empathetic but objective collecting the following critical data:

- Customer contact details and the exact date/time of the visit
- The specific item/food consumed and the onset time of the symptoms
- Remaining samples of the food (if available, these must be labeled and "quarantined" in the freezer for potential lab analysis)

5. Investigation and Root Cause Analysis

For all Category A complaints, the management must conduct a 24-hour internal audit:

- **Traceability Check:** All delivery logs for the raw materials used in that specific incident shall be reviewed by the Supply Chain Team.
- **Internal Monitoring:** The cold chain and holding logs for the day in question shall be checked by theSupply Chain Team along with Quality Assurance
- **Employee Health Check:** The investigation if any employee on duty that day was exhibiting symptoms of illness shall be handled by the Operations Team.

6. Regulatory Reporting and Recalls

If multiple independent complaints are received regarding the same item/ raw material, the **Crisis Management Team must**:

- **Stop Sale:** The management team shall halt the sale of the suspected product.
- **Quarantine:** The supply chain team and operations team shall isolate all remaining stock of the affected product
- **Report:** The management shall notify the local health office or the FDA if the suspected cause is a commercially processed ingredient.

7. Documentation and Review

All complaints must be recorded in the Customer Complaint Log by the Operations Team. The management shall review the aforementioned log monthly to identify the trends. If the same complaint occurs more than twice in a quarter, it shall trigger a mandatory system-wide review of the relevant SOP and employee retraining, spearheaded by the Quality Assurance and Learning & Development Team.

8. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	February 11, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA/RND Specialist**	Originator
1	March 05, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA/RND Specialist**	• Changed the addressing of personnel; staff members to employees • Changed store manager to restaurant and/or shift manager • Added additional signatory; L&D Manager
2	May 25, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Added Responsibilities

	Name	Position	Signature with Date
Prepared by	Marielle Louise Macabale	QA/RND Specialist	
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